

Vanessa Williams

Technical Account Management | Solution Design | Cloud Architecture & Strategy

Cloud professional with over 10 years of experience across infrastructure, Azure engineering and technical account management, combining a strong engineering foundation with customer-facing technical advisory and cloud strategy.

Currently working as an Azure Technical Account Manager, acting as a trusted advisor to SME and enterprise customers across cloud architecture, governance, security, resilience, cost optimisation and operational maturity. Experienced in translating business requirements into technical recommendations, identifying risks and improvement opportunities, and coordinating technical teams and vendors to deliver practical outcomes.

Broad Azure experience across networking, IaaS, application services, databases, backup, disaster recovery and AKS. I'm looking to progress further into cloud architecture, solutions consulting or senior technical advisory work, with more responsibility for solution design and cloud strategy.

SKILLS

Architecture & Design: Azure solution design, brownfield environments, requirements gathering, architecture reviews, cloud maturity

Governance & FinOps: Azure governance, Policy, cost optimisation, consumption analysis

Security & Resilience: Security posture, cloud risk, disaster recovery, high availability, business continuity

Azure Infrastructure: Networking, IaaS, application services, databases, backup, Site Recovery, AKS

Automation & IaC: PowerShell, Terraform

Customer & Consulting: Technical discovery, stakeholder management, requirements translation, technical roadmaps

Leadership & Delivery: Escalations, process ownership, cross-team coordination, mentoring

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

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Azure Technical Account Manager [Aug 2025 -]

Interim Azure Technical Account Manager [Jun 2023 - Mar 2024]

Act as a trusted technical advisor to a portfolio of SME and enterprise customers, combining Technical Account Management with hands-on technical discovery, solution design and architecture guidance.

- Lead proactive technical reviews across architecture, governance, security, resilience, monitoring, FinOps and cloud maturity.
- Gather business and technical requirements, assess existing brownfield environments and design practical Azure solutions aligned with best practices and customer constraints.
- Advise customers across Azure networking, infrastructure, security, disaster recovery, monitoring, patching and governance, helping them evaluate options and make informed design decisions.
- Identify architectural risks, technical debt, dependencies, cost inefficiencies and improvement opportunities, recommending both immediate remediation and longer-term initiatives.
- Develop technical roadmaps with customers, translating business objectives into prioritised recommendations and actionable work for engineering and Professional Services teams.
- Act as the technical bridge between customers, engineering teams, Microsoft and external vendors, coordinating complex escalations, technical discussions and solution delivery.
- Support FinOps and cloud optimisation activities, helping customers improve cost visibility, governance and control of Azure consumption.
- Maintain a proactive customer cadence covering technical health, ongoing risks, upcoming changes, strategic priorities and opportunities to improve the environment.

CERTIFICATIONS

Current Certifications

- MCSE: Core Infrastructure
- Azure Security Engineer
Associate

- Azure Network Engineer
Associate

Previously Held

- Azure Administrator Associate
- Azure Solutions Architect
Expert (recertification planned)
- Azure Database Administrator
Associate
- AWS Solutions Architect –
Associate

EDUCATION

Biomedical Sciences 2.1 BSc (Hons)

2011 to 2014

King's College London

Activities: Mentoring & Tutoring

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY (continued...)

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Azure Cloud Engineer II [May 2021 – Aug 2025]

Worked across complex Azure customer environments, combining hands-on engineering, solution design, technical discovery and customer advisory. Alongside the engineering role, acted as one of the first TAMs in a newly established global TAM function.

- Delivered engineering and operational support across Azure networking, IaaS, application services, databases, backup, Site Recovery and AKS.
- Designed solutions for brownfield Azure environments, gathering requirements and balancing Azure best practice with existing technical and operational constraints.
- Led technical discovery and design validation, identifying dependencies, risks and blockers and recommending practical implementation approaches.
- Acted as an escalation point for complex Azure issues and coordinated Microsoft cases and cross-team technical work.
- Served as Maintenance and Onboarding Process Owner, improving documentation, consistency and team processes.
- Helped establish the early TAM operating model, including proactive customer cadence, review activities and repeatable technical workloads.
- Mentored colleagues and contributed to technical knowledge sharing across the team.

Windows Support Engineer [Apr 2018 - May 2021]

Delivered Windows infrastructure support across enterprise customer environments, with additional ownership of complex technical escalations and platform improvements.

Completed a five-month secondment within Metro Bank's Infrastructure Team, acting as a technical lead on projects including deployment and troubleshooting of Azure Windows Virtual Desktop.

Served as an SSL and Sophos SME and coordinated complex technical issues across internal teams.

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ES Team Leader / System Administrator [Sep 2017 – Feb 2018]

ES Engineer / System Administrator [Jun 2014 – Sep 2017]

Progressed from System Administrator to Team Leader within an enterprise engineering environment supporting government and financial-sector clients

Led pivotal technical projects, platform improvements and application/infrastructure upgrades; coordinated engineering teams and external suppliers; conducted technical review meetings with customers; and supported team development, mentoring and resource management.